Can a Machine Think? KEY

Name _____

Work with a partner. Compare answers when you finish each problem.

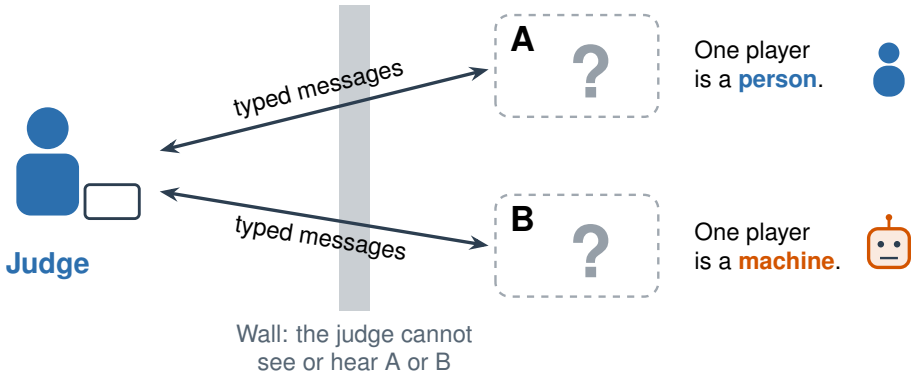
Word bank: judge machine passes person typed

1. Is it thinking? Check one box for each.

	Yes	No	Not sure
A calculator adds 375 + 498.	☐	☐	☐
A dog finds its way home.	☐	☐	☐
A phone opens when it sees your face.	☐	☐	☐
You solve a puzzle.	☐	☐	☐
A plant turns toward the sun.	☐	☐	☐
A chatbot writes a poem.	☐	☐	☐

Answers vary. People do not agree on what "thinking" means. That is the point.

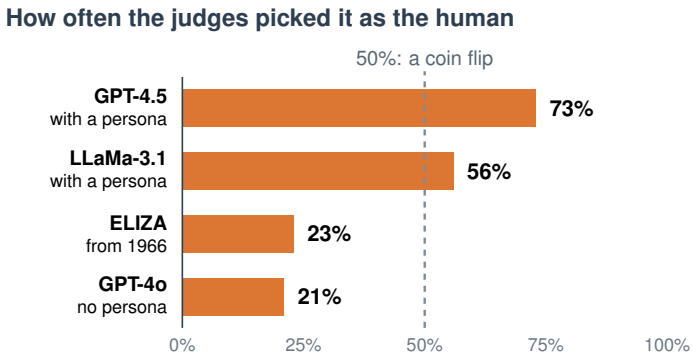
2. The imitation game (the Turing test)



A judge asks questions. One player is a person, and one is a machine.

The judge only reads typed answers. If the judge cannot tell, the machine passes.

3. Has a machine passed? (a test from 2025)



Which chatbot was picked as the human most often? GPT-4.5 (73% of the time)

What did the scientists tell it to pretend to be? a shy young person who uses slang

4. Play the imitation game. Work in a group of 3 or 4: judge, human player, AI helper (and scorekeeper).

Round	The judge's question	The judge **picked** (A or B)	**Was the judge right?** (yes / no)
1	Answers vary.		
2			
3			
4			
5			

The judge was right _____ times.

Our best question for catching the AI: Answers vary. Example: What is the weather now?

5. Talk about it. If a machine fools you, does that mean it thinks?

If a machine fools me, it **does** / **does not** mean the machine thinks, because Answers vary.

Go Further (Day 2). The persona experiment. The judge was right . . .

with **no** persona: _____ out of 5 with the persona: _____ out of 5 Harder to catch: Answers vary.

✂ *Cut out the cards. Add them to the class timeline.*

1950

Alan Turing asks: **Can a machine think?** He invents the imitation game (the Turing test).

Draw a picture here.

2025

In a Turing test, judges pick a chatbot as the human **73%** of the time. It used a persona.

Draw a picture here.